



Product Launching With Product Hunt in 4 Steps

An EWOR Checklist

Launching on Product Hunt (PH) is more than just hitting “Submit”. It’s a unique opportunity to reach early adopters, gather valuable feedback, and build momentum around your product.

This checklist breaks the process down into four essential steps—so whether you’re launching your MVP or your next big feature, you’ll know exactly what to do before, during, and after launch day to make it count.

If you’re looking for a more detailed overview, we recommend this [guide](#).

Step 1

Set the Foundation for a Successful Launch

Before you go live, make sure you’ve set yourself—and your product—up for a strong launch day.

This step will help you understand how Product Hunt works, get involved in the community, define your launch goals, and gather everything you’ll need to make the most of your moment.

1 Create Your Product Hunt Account

Before you can launch, you’ll need a personal Product Hunt account—not a company profile.

There’s a one-week waiting period before you’re allowed to post, so don’t leave this step to the last minute. Creating your profile early also helps you look credible and discoverable.

✓ To do:

- Sign up for a **free personal account** at producthunt.com
- Add a **profile picture**, short bio, and links to your website and social profiles
- Make sure anyone involved in your launch (e.g. co-founders, teammates) does the same

2 Spend Time in the Community

Product Hunt is more than a launch board—it’s a community.

Engaging with others beforehand gives you a better sense of how the platform works and improves your post’s visibility once you go live.

The algorithm tends to favour active, authentic users.

✓ To do:

- Spend at least **15 minutes/day** engaging with other products: upvote, comment, follow
- Use this time to learn what successful launches look like
- Encourage your team and early users to create accounts and start interacting
- Continue engaging for **15 minutes before your own launch post** to give it a visibility boost

3 Decide when to launch

Not sure if your product is ready? That’s okay. There’s no single right answer.

Some makers launch early to gather feedback; others wait until their product is more polished. In some cases, momentum builds unexpectedly, and the best move is to launch fast and ride the wave.

✓ To do:

- Decide which launch style fits your needs:
 - **Early launch** for fast feedback
 - **Refined launch** after private testing
 - **Opportunistic launch** if buzz builds unexpectedly
- Plan to post in the **morning (PT)** to maximise time on the homepage
- Coordinate with your team and any collaborators in advance

4 Set clear, measurable goals

Success on Product Hunt isn’t one-size-fits-all. Upvotes and leaderboard rankings are great, but there are many other ways to define success, depending on your product and company goals.

Knowing your goals upfront helps you focus your messaging and measure results meaningfully.

✓ To do:

Choose 2–3 specific outcomes to aim for, such as:

- Feedback from early adopters
- Email signups, sales, or traffic
- Social proof (comments, testimonials, reviews)
- Brand exposure or media/investor interest
- Hiring or community growth
- Product validation or user interviews

5 Decide who will post (a.k.a. the “hunter”)

The person who posts your product is called the hunter. It’s totally normal—and even encouraged—for makers to post their own products.

You don’t need a “famous” hunter to succeed, and you should never pay someone to post or promote your launch.

✓ To do:

- Decide whether you’ll post your product or ask someone else (a co-maker or happy user is ideal)
- Avoid anyone offering paid “hunting” or promotion—this goes against Product Hunt rules
- Know that **self-hunted products** often do just as well (or better)

6 Prepare your launch assets

Having all your launch content ready ahead of time reduces stress and improves your chances of making a great first impression.

This includes copy, visuals, and everything you’ll need to communicate your product clearly and memorably.

✓ To do:

Prepare the following assets:

- **Product name and tagline** (short, clear, and benefit-focused—maximum 60 characters)
- **Short and long descriptions** (1–2 lines and a few paragraphs)
- **Thumbnail image** (240x240px, simple and eye-catching)
- **Gallery images or GIFs** (3–5, showcasing the product)
- **Demo video** (optional, but helpful for complex products)
- **First comment post** (introduce yourself, share your “why,” and invite feedback)
- **Relevant links** (website, signup page, or app store link)

Step 2

Plan Your Launch

You’ve laid the foundation — now it’s time to prepare for your actual launch. This step covers when to launch, how to submit your product, what content to prepare, and how to write your first comment.

1 Choose the right time to launch

There’s no single “best day” to launch on Product Hunt — it depends on your goals, product, and momentum. That said, there are some patterns that can guide your decision.

✓ To do:

- Aim to post at **12:01am PT** for full-day visibility on the homepage (Product Hunt resets daily on Pacific Time).
- Weekdays are popular with bigger launches, but **weekends** can be great for indie makers — fewer launches and 15% more click-throughs.
- If your product is trending elsewhere (e.g., on X/Twitter), don’t wait — ride the momentum.
- Align with media buzz: if you’ve arranged press coverage, coordinate your launch time to maximise visibility.
- Pick a day or time when **you and your team can be online** to respond to comments and share.

2 Submit your product when you’re ready to launch

Submitting your product is straightforward and open to anyone with a personal Product Hunt account.

You can either launch immediately or schedule up to one month in advance.

✓ To do:

- Log in and click “**Submit**” → “**New Product**”
- Enter your product’s **URL** (no shortened or UTM links)
- Choose to **launch now** or **schedule for later**
- **Optional but recommended:** Create a teaser to build interest early — it shows up in the “Coming Soon” feed and lets users follow your product before launch. If working in stealth, you can skip teasers and just publish quietly

3 Prepare your launch content

You’ll fill in several fields when submitting — each one helps position your product clearly to the community. Having everything ready makes the process smoother and more strategic.

✓ To do:

- **Product name:** Just the name (no emojis or descriptions)
- **Tagline** (max 60 characters): Simple and clear explanation of what your product does
- **Description** (max 260 characters): Key features + value prop
- **Website URL:** direct link to your landing page, app, or store
- **Additional links:** App Store, GitHub, etc. (optional)
- **X/Twitter handle:** Preferably your product’s, not personal (optional)
- **Tags** (up to 3): Choose relevant launch categories
- **Thumbnail** (240x240px): Static or GIF image, <3MB
- **Gallery images** (min. 2, 1270x760px): Screenshots, product flows, or GIFs
- **Video** (optional): YouTube demo or intro
- **Interactive demo** (optional): Tools like Loom, Supademo, or Storylane work well
- **Makers:** Add teammates by their Product Hunt usernames
- **Shoutouts:** Up to 3 tools/services that helped you build
- **Pricing:** Free, Paid, or Paid w/ Free Trial
- **Promo code** (optional): Offer something exclusive to the PH community

4 Write your first comment

This is one of the most important parts of your launch. Your first comment shows up right below your product gallery and sets the tone for the entire discussion.

✓ To do:

- Introduce yourself and your team
- Explain what your product does and who it’s for
- Highlight key features or use cases
- Share your “why” — what problem are you solving, and how did this product come to be?
- Mention pricing, if relevant
- Ask for feedback (not upvotes!)
- Use bullet points or emojis for clarity
- Add GIFs, images, or links if they help tell your story
- Be authentic and avoid marketing jargon

🔗 Pro Tip

70% of Product of the Day/Week/Month winners had a maker comment. The more personal and helpful, the better.

Share Your Launch

Getting noticed on Product Hunt takes more than just hitting “Submit.” This step will help you build anticipation before launch day, promote your product effectively when it goes live, and engage your community without being spammy.

1 Warm up your community before launch

Product Hunt is a community-first platform. If your only interaction is posting your own launch, it'll feel transactional—and your visibility may suffer. Start showing up early and create touchpoints with your audience in advance.

✓ **To do:**

- Tease your launch in advance on X/Twitter, LinkedIn, Discord, Slack, or your newsletter
- Encourage your community to **create Product Hunt accounts ahead of time** and follow your “Coming Soon” page
- Use the **Coming Soon banner** to drive interest and followers
- Build in public: post updates, share milestones, ask questions, and engage in relevant discussions (e.g., *#buildinginpublic*)
- Host an AMA on Product Hunt to generate early interest
- Invite your team to engage too—momentum builds faster with a group effort

2 Polish your Product Hunt profile

Your profile gets more attention than usual during and after launch. Make sure it reflects you and your work.

✓ **To do:**

- Update your **About** section with your experience, links, and current role
- Add your **website and socials**
- Be clear about what you're building or working on next
- Grow followers ahead of time to support future launches

3 Set up a focused landing page

Your homepage is often the first thing new users will see. A clear, distraction-free landing page tailored to Product Hunt visitors can boost conversions.

✓ **To do:**

- Create a dedicated landing page with your product's core value, CTA, and optional **Product Hunt-exclusive offer**
- Keep it focused—avoid clutter and extra navigation
- Add **badges/embeds** from your Product Hunt launch page to drive traffic and build social proof

4 Promote your launch on launch day

This is when your preparation pays off. Your job now is to get the word out and show up in conversations.

✓ **To do:**

- Share your launch across all relevant channels:
 - X/Twitter
 - LinkedIn (don't forget to update your header and bio)
 - Newsletters
 - Community platforms where you're active (i.e. the EWOR Slack Channel)
 - In-app banners or notifications (if you have a product live)
- Use the **Product Hunt badge** on your site
- Monitor your **Launch Day Dashboard** to track comments, reviews, and upvotes
- Be present: respond to every comment and thank supporters in real-time
- Coordinate with your team to manage replies, answer questions, and repost positive mentions

5 Follow the rules (How not to market)

The Product Hunt community values authentic engagement and will spot (and report) spammy behaviour fast. Don't let short-term tactics ruin your long-term trust.

× **Avoid:**

- Asking for upvotes directly on the platform
- Running contests or giveaways tied to upvotes
- Spamming users with cold DMs or mass emails
- Paying someone to promote or “hunt” your product

✓ **Instead:**

- Ask for feedback
- Ask people to check out your post and share if they find it valuable
- Focus on building conversations, not clicks

6 Watch out for common mistakes

A lot of makers miss the mark simply because they didn't plan ahead. Avoiding these pitfalls can make a huge difference in the quality of your launch.

× **Don't:**

- Wait until launch day to tell people about your product
- Skip creating a proper landing page
- Forget to update your Product Hunt and LinkedIn profiles
- Launch late in the day if you have the option to post early
- Assume Product of the Day is the only goal that matters
- Think you need a famous hunter or pay someone to post on your behalf

Post-Launch Momentum

Launch day may be over, but this is where long-term traction begins. From building social proof to collecting reviews and preparing for relaunches, this step helps you use your momentum wisely—day by day and week by week.



What Happens After Launch?

📅 **Day 1–3 (Launch Afterglow):**

- Stay active on Product Hunt: respond to comments and thank supporters
- Share your launch page on social media and through your newsletter
- Begin lightly following up with supporters and early adopters
- Celebrate—but don't disappear!

🗉 **Day 4–7 (Build Momentum):**

- Collect feedback and respond to new comments
- Encourage users to leave reviews
- Leverage your Product Hunt success with badges, embeds, and social proof
- Continue promoting your Product Hunt link—it still drives traffic all week
- Update your Product Hub if you haven't already

🗓️ **Week 2+: (Sustain Growth):**

- Nurture leads with drip emails and exclusive offers
- Post updates or roadmap plans based on user feedback
- Prepare for possible relaunch (if your product evolves significantly)

1 Follow Up with Supporters

Stay human, say thanks, and keep the conversation going. Lead nurturing takes time—follow-ups often convert better than first touches.

✓ **To do:**

- Respond to every comment (even post-launch) on your PH page
- Thank users publicly and privately
- Remind users of any PH-only promo you offered
- Follow up via email (if collected) and enrol in a value-driven drip campaign
- Share mini updates (e.g., “We fixed that thing you mentioned!”)

2 Collect and Use Feedback

User feedback is product gold. Analyse it carefully. Mentioning users in future releases builds loyalty and shows you're listening.

✓ **To do:**

- Organise feedback from comments, social posts, and email
- Categorise by type (UX issues, bugs, ideas, praise)
- Share useful quotes/testimonials with your team and in marketing
- Respond to thoughtful feedback—even weeks later
- Track which updates were made thanks to community input

3 Encourage Reviews

Reviews are critical for long-term visibility on Product Hunt and search engines. Social proof builds credibility. You're in great company—many top startups use their PH badge for years.

✓ **To do:**

- Ask your earliest users to leave a review
- Embed the “Leave a Review” badge on your website or in-app
- Send a follow-up email with a review link and thank-you note
- Monitor reviews and respond promptly (via email or Slack alerts)

4 Use Badges and Embeds for Social Proof

Show off your PH success everywhere you can.

✓ **To do:**

- Add the Featured, Award, or Product of the Day badge to your site
- Use embeds on your blog, media page, or landing page
- Promote your PH win on LinkedIn and X/Twitter
- Share it in your newsletter and with press outlets

5 Use Badges and Embeds for Social Proof

Your Product Hub becomes your long-term home on Product Hunt. Keep it fresh and discoverable. Think of it as your ongoing profile for discovery on PH—even beyond launch day.

✓ **To do:**

- Claim your Product Hub if you haven't already
- Add your product's history, team members, updates, and awards
- Link to blog posts, press, job listings, and more
- Drive traffic to it from your site and socials

6 Relaunch (If Applicable)

Big new feature? Major pivot? You might be eligible for another Product Hunt launch. Plenty of products have launched multiple times on Product Hunt—as long as it's meaningful and community-driven.

✓ **To do:**

- Review Product Hunt's re-launch guidelines (wait 6 months unless it's a significant update)
- If it's a major product update or pivot, request early re-launch approval via their form
- Use feedback from your first launch to guide the messaging of the next
- Plan your next launch with fresh assets, a new tagline, and improved positioning

